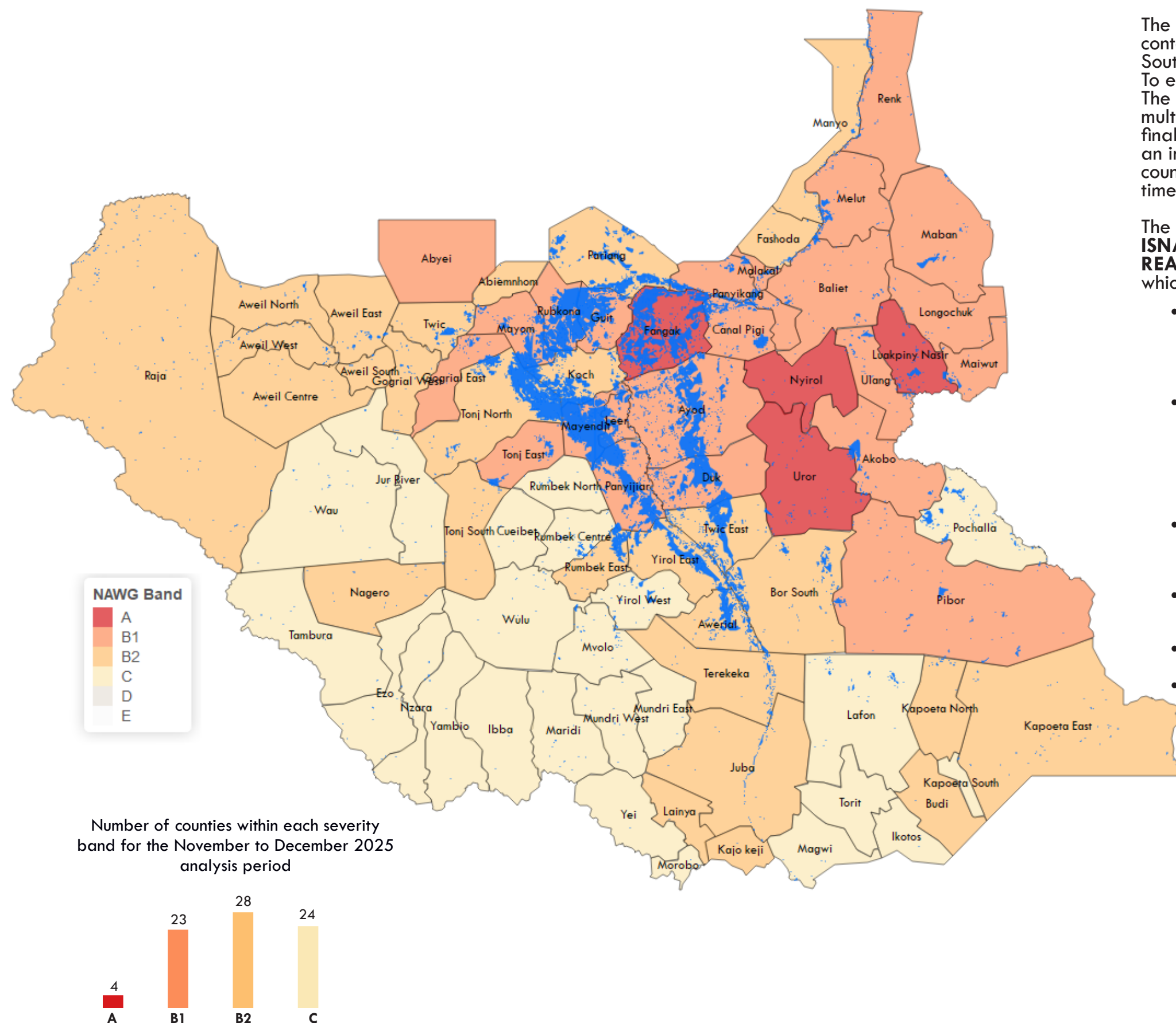


SOUTH SUDAN – NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

November – December 2025 Analysis



For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Kumudu Sanjeewa (sanjeewa@un.org) or Mary Langan (mary.langan@impact-initiatives.org).

Background

The NAWG meeting was held on January 20, 2026 to discuss the analysis of the **November to December** period.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of critical life-saving humanitarian needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization by the ICCG. To enable this, the NAWG analytical framework (NAF) was developed. The NAF provides a systematic approach to interpret a wide array of multi-sectoral information and monitor needs at the county-level. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The NAF encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, JMMI, ACLED, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
 - Armed conflict events and/or conflict-related sexual violence and/or forced recruitment of children and/or targeted killings of civilians and/or targeted property destruction
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used as a proxy for life-threatening acute malnutrition and excess mortality risk.

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B1	7 - 7.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (higher severity)
B2	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (lower severity)
C	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
D	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
E	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

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November – December 2025 Analysis

The November–December 2025 NAWG analysis reveals that humanitarian severity remains extremely high nationwide, with all 79 counties classified between Bands A–C. A key shift this cycle is a notable expansion of Band B1 (Severe), rising from 13 to 23 counties (+10). This shift is driven primarily by a widespread escalation in disease indicators alongside a moderate uptick in protection risks, even as overall displacement flows slightly eased at national level.

The most acute deterioration discussed this cycle is linked to the late December escalation of conflict in Jonglei, which rapidly intensified humanitarian risks through restricted access, reported mass displacement, and heightened protection concerns. In this context, Uror and Nyirol were classified in Band A amid severe access constraints (including a declared “no-fly zone” and restrictions on road movement) and high shock indicator scores, while conflict dynamics also affected Ayod and Duk, where airstrikes/clashes and large displacement reports led partners to flag these counties for close monitoring.

Counties Facing “Extreme” Humanitarian Conditions

Four counties were classified as exhibiting extreme humanitarian needs (Band A) in this analysis period. **Fangak** and **Nasir** were automatically classified as **Band A** for having pockets of the population experiencing IPC Phase 5 (Catastrophe) conditions. **Nyirol** and **Uror** were also classified as **Band A** due to the compounding impact of high protection risks, significant displacement, and severe disease burdens.

Discussion and Joint Analysis

- **Abyei:** Flagged due to worsening public health, security, and displacement pressures. A severe Hepatitis E outbreak in 2025, alongside rising Hepatitis B cases and critical medicine shortages as health services are overwhelmed. Security is reportedly deteriorating, with UNISFA warning of increased troop presence in violation of the area’s demilitarized status. These risks are compounded by continued displacement, including returnees from Upper Nile State and refugee influxes from Sudan. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1.**
- **Ayod:** Flagged due to dynamic conflict shifting toward central and eastern Jonglei. Opposition forces captured locations in Uror and Ayod counties. Specific incidents include aerial bombardments in Mogok Payam on December 2nd resulting in civilian casualties, and armed clashes in Wau and Kuach Deng Payams in early January. Access is severely limited by road and conflict restricts supply movements. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1.**

- **Duk:** Flagged due to the evolving security situation, heightened civilian risks, and restricted access. Local authorities report over 30,000 people displaced by fighting in Pajut Payam and over 180,000 people displaced across Jonglei by renewed fighting between late December and mid-January. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1, added to close monitoring.**
- **Akobo:** Flagged due to displacement reports, with local authorities reporting 9,500 people displaced. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1, added to close monitoring.**
- **Koch:** Flagged due to armed clashes on January 15th in Wang-Rew Village, resulting in fatalities. While the situation is reportedly calm but unpredictable, NGOs are advised to avoid non-essential movements. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B2.**
- **Rubkona:** Flagged due to increased reports of violence across the county, including within the Bentiu IDP camp where armed clashes reportedly occurred on January 4th. The CCCM cluster has warned that service delivery in the camp is at a bare minimum with no funding visibility for critical services from Q2 2026. Unconfirmed reports suggest 25,000 people were displaced in the second week of January. Increased clashes related to cattle raiding and unexpected flood water increases were also noted. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1.**
- **Renk:** Flagged due to consistent arrivals from Sudan (2,800-3,500 weekly) and severe malnutrition, with screenings indicating 1 in 4 children in the Eastern Corridor are malnourished. Water shortages, inadequate sanitation, and restricted healthcare persist. Water issues remain a major concern due to funding gaps and sporadic rainfall. Partners noted that displacement flows are bi-directional, but significant influxes are possible if the situation in Sudan degrades. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1, added to close monitoring.**
- **Manyo:** Flagged following a fact-finding mission on January 10th in Wadakona, which confirmed an estimated 15,000 new returnee arrivals from Sudan across Wadakona, Kaka, and Magenes payams in December 2025. Returnees face severe conditions, stretching host community capacity. A rapid inter-agency assessment is planned. Access and water availability are major issues in the county. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B2, added to close monitoring.**
- **Nagero:** Flagged for follow-up on displacement from earlier conflict. While active clashes have subsided, tensions remain high. On December 27th, an armed clash occurred in Ngoni River related to reported forced recruitment attempts. Operational partner presence remains low, and OCHA was unable to access the area

to map partner presence in December. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B2.**

- **Tambura:** Flagged due to conflict in the CAR-DRC-South Sudan border region displacing refugees and returnees. Civilians from CAR reportedly fled into Source Yubu Payam starting December 28th following attacks on the border town of Bambuti. Displaced civilians reportedly lack adequate food, water, and housing. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Kapoeta East:** Flagged due to armed clashes on January 17th in Narus Town, leading to displacement. Partners also expressed concern over unverified reports of Marburg disease; the Health Cluster clarified there is no outbreak in South Sudan, but WHO has a team on the ground for preparedness. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B2, added to close monitoring.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to gather more information and closely track the evolving situation. Partners are requested to pay close attention to these counties and share any relevant information.

- **Fangak (Band A):** Continued monitoring due to extreme flooding affecting 150,000 people and IPC analysis projecting catastrophic food insecurity for 5% of the population.
- **Nasir (Band A):** Continued monitoring due to projected catastrophic food insecurity (5% of population) and IPC AMN Phase 5 classification.
- **Uror (Band A):** Continued monitoring due to intense hostilities since late December, including daily airstrikes and bombardments, reportedly displacing over 105,000 people.
- **Nyirol (Band A):** Continued monitoring due to airstrikes, including one on Lankien market on December 29th resulting in casualties. Intense clashes have reportedly displaced 57,200 people.
- **Tonj East (Band B1):** Continued monitoring due to recent humanitarian situation and inter-communal violence.
- **Bor South (Band B2):** Continued monitoring following an attack on November 19th in Makuach Payam resulting in fatalities, with reported presence of armed youth groups.
- **Torit (Band C):** Continued monitoring due to high insecurity and violent incidents in November-December, following earlier displacement of over 3,000 people to schools and churches with limited access to basic needs.